Sergiu **Lipcean**

Research Fellow

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Professional Experience

- *12/2022–present*: **Research Fellow**, Department of Comparative Politics, University of Bergen — ERC project 'ConsultationEffects': Effects of Stakeholder Consultations on Inputs, Processes and Outcomes of Executive Policymaking, Bergen, Norway.
- *11/2020–10/2022*: **Marie Curie Research Fellow**, School of Law and Government, Dublin City University — Horizon 2020 project 'PFCORR': Does Public Funding Matter?, Dublin, Ireland.
- *09/2019–08/2020*: **Politics Lecturer**, State University 'Dimitrie Cantemir' — Subjects taught: Research Methods, Comparative Politics, Chisinau, Moldova.
- *01/2009–02/2020*: **Associated Political Expert**, Institute for Development and Social Initiatives 'Viitorul' — Areas of expertise: party and campaign financing, education policies, parliamentary monitoring, Chisinau, Moldova.
- *09/2007–07/2011*: **Politics Lecturer**, University of Political and Economic European Studies — Subjects taught: Introduction to Public Policy, Contemporary Political Ideas, Comparative Politics, Chisinau, Moldova.
- *09/2006–06/2008*: **Politics Lecturer**, State Institute of International Relations — Subjects taught: Introduction to Public Policy, Contemporary Political Ideas, Chisinau, Moldova.
- *09/2001–06/2007*: **Politics Lecturer**, Institute of Political Studies and International Relations — Subjects taught: Introduction to Public Policy, Contemporary Political Ideas, Comparative Politics, Chisinau, Moldova.

Education

- *09/2014–04/2019*: **PhD in Political and Social Sciences**, European University Institute, Florence, Italy — Dissertation: *Similar Challenges, Different Outcomes? The Development of Political Financing Regimes in Post-Communist Space*.
- *09/2013–08/2014*: **MRes in Political and Social Sciences**, European University Institute, Florence, Italy.
- *09/2011–09/2013*: **MA in East European and Eurasian Studies**, University of Bologna (Forlì Campus), Italy.
- *09/1999–06/2001*: **Postgraduate Studies in Political Sciences**, National School of Political and Administrative Studies, Bucharest, Romania.
- *09/1998–06/1999*: **MA in History**, Moldova State University, Chisinau, Moldova.
- *09/1993–06/1998*: **BA in History**, Moldova State University, Chisinau, Moldova.

Research Grants, Fellowships & Projects

- *09/2023–08/2027*: **Principal Investigator**, Pathway Programme Research Fellowship — Irish Research Council & Science Foundation Ireland, Dublin City University, Ireland (€436,035).[1]
- *11/2020–10/2022*: **Marie Curie Postdoctoral Fellow**, Marie Skłodowska Curie Actions Individual Fellowship — Horizon 2020, Dublin City University, Ireland (PFCorr, Grant agreement ID: 895004 - €184,590).

[1] I have declined the awarded research grant for family reasons.

- *09/2016–08/2017*: **PhD Fellowship**, European University Institute — Internal funding (€15,360), Florence, Italy.
- *09/2013–08/2016*: **PhD Fellowship**, European University Institute — Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs grant (€41,400), Florence, Italy.
- *12/2017–04/2018*: **Researcher**, Political Finance Database project, International IDEA, Stockholm, Sweden.
- *02/2017–04/2017*: **Research Assistant**, ERC Project *POLCON*, European University Institute, Florence, Italy.
- *05/2015–12/2015*: **Research Assistant**, ERC Project *POLCON*, European University Institute, Florence, Italy.
- *11/2013–05/2014*: **Research Assistant**, Project *EUandI* – Voting Advice Application for the 2014 EP elections, European University Institute, Florence, Italy.

Selected Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- Bunea, A., Lipcean, S. & Rauh, C. (2026). Responsive to What? Explaining the Information Quality of Public Comments on Bureaucratic Policymaking Using a Text-as-Data Approach. Governance 39(2): e70122. DOI: https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1111/gove.70122
- Bunea, A. & Lipcean, S. (2026). Does public participation in supranational policymaking enhance the European Commission's legislative agenda-setting success? Journal of European Public Policy. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2026.2623923
- Casal Bértoa F., Horncastle W. & Lipcean S. (2025) Blessing or Curse? A Critical Review of the Paradoxical Consequences of Direct Public Funding for Political Parties. European Political Science Review 1–21. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1017/S1755773925100258
- Lipcean, S. & Casal Bértoa, F. (2024) Do political finance reforms really reduce corruption? A replication study. Research & Politics 11(4): 1-9. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1177/20531680241310002
- Lipcean, S. & McMenamin, I. (2024). Rethinking public funding of parties and corruption: Confronting theoretical complexity and challenging measurement. Governance 37(2): 537–559. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/gove.12782
- Bunea, A., Wüest, R. & Lipcean, S. (2024). Mapping the policy space of public stakeholder consultations: Evidence from the European Union. Journal of European Public Policy. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2024.2320836
- Bunea, A. & Lipcean, S. (2023). Understanding patterns of stakeholder participation in public commenting on bureaucratic policymaking: Evidence from the European Union. Regulation & Governance. DOI: https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1111/rego.12551
- Lipcean, S. (2022). Direct public funding of political parties: Between proxy measures and hard data. Party Politics 28(6): 1041–1057. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1177/13540688211037302

Datasets

- Lipcean, S. (2021). Dataset on direct public funding of political parties across post-communist regimes 1990-2020. Harvard Dataverse. DOI: https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/TNHZML

Book Chapters

- Lipcean, S. & Casal Bértoa, F. (2024). Political Financing and Political Corruption. In L. de Sousa & S. Coroado (eds.), Elgar Encyclopedia of Corruption and Society. DOI: https://doi.org/10.4337/9781803925806.ch59
- Lipcean, S. & Prohnitchi, E. (2024). Against The Mainstream? The Impact of Party Regulation in Political Competition in Moldova. In F. Casal Bértoa & L. Tsutskiridze (eds.), Money Rules: Parties, Oligarchs and Funding Regulation in Post-Soviet Countries. Routledge, Taylor & Francis Group. DOI: https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003272236-2

Policy Briefs & Reports

- Lipcean, S. (2026). Campaign Financing in Moldova's 2025 Parliamentary Elections. In J. M. Dollbaum & A. Eaglestone (eds), The Parliamentary Elections of 2025 II. University of Fribourg/CH; Research Centre for East European Studies (FSO) at the University of Bremen; Center for Security Studies (CSS) at ETH Zurich; Center for Eastern European Studies (CEES) at the University of Zurich. DOI: https://doi.org/10.3929/ethz-c-000793910
- Lipcean, S., Casal Bértoa, F. & Goguadze, N. (2022). Post-legislative scrutiny of election campaign finance legislation. London: Westminster Foundation for Democracy. URL: https://www.wfd.org/what-we-do/resources/post-legislative-scrutiny-election-campaign-finance-legislation
- Berbeca, V. & Lipcean, S. (2020). National Army: Between Group Interests and Strategic Development. Institute of Public Policies (ro). URL: https://ipp.md/wp-content/uploads/2020/06/Armata-Nationala-intre-interese-de-grup-si-dezvotare-strategica1.pdf
- Lipcean, S. & Turcan, R. (2020). Higher Education in Moldova at Crossroads or Throwing Good Money After Bad? Chisinau: Friedrich Ebert Stiftung. URL: https://moldova.fes.de/fileadmin/user_upload/2020/Publications/Studiu_invatamant_Superior_final_1_EN.pdf
- Lipcean, S. (2018). Drawing Electoral Districts Boundaries: Between Neutrality and Political Partisanship. Chisinau: Friedrich Ebert Stiftung, IDIS 'Viitorul'. URL: https://moldova.fes.de/fileadmin/user_upload/2018/publications/Policy_brief-Gerrymandering-eng.pdf
- Lipcean, S. (2017). Problems and Challenges in the Financing of Parliamentary Elections in the Context of Changing the Electoral System. Chisinau: Friedrich Ebert Stiftung, IDIS 'Viitorul'. URL: https://moldova.fes.de/fileadmin/user_upload/2017/publications/Policy_brief-finantare_campanii-ENG.pdf
- Lipcean, S. & Ştefan, L. (2014). Implementing Right to Information: A Case Study of Moldova. In S. E. Trapnell (ed.), Right to Information: Case Studies on Implementation. Washington, DC: World Bank. URL: https://openknowledge.worldbank.org/handle/10986/22527
- Ciurea, C., Gurin, M., Lipcean, S. & Berbeca V. (2012) Higher Education System of Moldova in the Context of the Bologna Process: 2005 – 2011. Soros Foundation Moldova & Institute for Development and Social Initiatives (IDIS "Viitorul") (ro). URL: https://soros.md/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/Studiu-Procesul-Bologna-2005-2011.pdf
- Lipcean, S. (2011) Free and Fair Elections. In The Audit of the Democratic System of Republic of Moldova: Anthology of Analysis on Governance. Institute for Development and Social Initiatives (IDIS "Viitorul"), pp. 80-113. URL: http://www.viitorul.org/files/Audit_EN%20%281%29.pdf
- Lipcean, S. (2011) The Democratic Role of Political Parties. In The Audit of the Democratic System of Republic of Moldova: Anthology of Analysis on Governance. Institute for Development and Social Initiatives (IDIS "Viitorul"), pp. 114-142.

- Lipcean, S. (2011) Government Effectiveness and Accountability. In The Audit of the Democratic System of Republic of Moldova: Anthology of Analysis on Governance. Institute for Development and Social Initiatives (IDIS "Viitorul"), pp. 143-164.
- Lipcean, S. (2011) Vocational Education at Crossroads: A Policy Decision Analysis of the Post–Secondary Vocational Education System of Moldova. Institute for Development and Social Initiatives (IDIS "Viitorul") (ro). http://www.viitorul.org/files/10_3.pdf
- Ciurea, C. & Lipcean, S. (2011). Financing of Political Parties in the 2011 Local Elections: a Sample of Medieval Relations (No. 6). Chișinău: IDIS 'Viitorul' (ro). URL: http://www.viitorul.org/files/library/POLITICI_PUBLICE_6%20Finantare%20partide.pdf
- Lipcean, S., Ciurea, C., Litra, L. & Cozonac, C. (2010). Financing Political Parties: Between Transparency and Obscurity (No. 8). Chișinău: IDIS 'Viitorul'. URL: http://www.viitorul.org/files/POLITICI_PUBLICE_8_finante%20partide%20eng.pdf
- Lipcean, S. (2009). Assessing the Financing of Political Parties and Election Campaigns in the Republic of Moldova (No. 5). Chișinău: IDIS 'Viitorul' (ro). URL: http://www.viitorul.org/files/25.pdf

Method training

- *02/2022*: **ECPR Winter School (Virtual)** — Courses: *Machine Learning with Big Data (R)*, *Social Network Analysis (R)*.
- *08/2021*: **ECPR Summer School (Virtual)** — Courses: *Structural Equation Modelling (R)*, *Quantitative Text Analysis (R)*, *Statistics of Causal Inference (R)*.
- *03/2021*: **ECPR Winter School (Virtual)** — Courses: *Panel Data Analysis (R)*, *Multilevel Modelling (R)*.
- *05/2017*: **Workshop**, European University Institute — *A Primer to Web Scraping with R*.
- *05/2017*: **Workshop**, European University Institute — *Qualitative Comparative Analysis (QCA) with R*.
- *05/2016*: **Workshop**, European University Institute — *QCA and Fuzzy Sets*.
- *03/2016*: **Workshop**, European University Institute — *Introduction to Data Analysis with R*.
- *05/2015*: **Workshop**, European University Institute — *Introduction to Panel Data Analysis*.
- *02/2015*: **Workshops**, European University Institute — *Causal Inference: Design-Based Identification Strategies*; *Social-Scientific Network Analysis*; *Categorical Dependent Variables*.

Selected Conference Presentations

- *08/2024*: **IPSA-RC20 – Political Finance and Political Corruption Biennial Meeting**, Oxford University, UK — *Presentation:* Party funding control and corruption: Evidence from the European Union.
- *07/2024*: **Money in Politics in the Era of Globalization and Digitalization**, Chisinau, Moldova — *Presentation:* The Challenges of Party Funding Control.
- *06/2024*: **8th Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Forum**, Lisbon, Portugal — *Presentation:* Hide-and-Seek: Untangling Judicial Corruption Through the Scrutiny of Income and Asset Declarations.
- *11/2023*: **CERIS Workshop on Anti-Corruption**, European Commission, Brussels, Belgium — *Presentation:* The Impact of Public Funding of Political Parties on Political Corruption.
- *09/2023*: **ECPR General Conference**, Prague, Czechia — *Presentation:* Does public funding of political parties affect party systems and electoral competition? Evidence from the post-communist space.

- *07/2023*: **ECPR Biennial Conference of the Standing Group on Regulatory Governance**, Antwerp, Belgium — *Presentation:* Understanding patterns of public commenting on bureaucratic policymaking: Evidence from the European Union.
- *09/2022*: **APSA Annual Meeting & Exhibition**, Montreal, Canada — *Presentation:* Does Public Funding of Parties Reduce Corruption? Evidence from Firm-Level Data.
- *07/2022*: **IPSA-RC20 – Political Finance and Political Corruption Biennial Meeting**, Prague, Czechia — *Presentation:* Does public funding of parties reduce corruption? Evidence from firm-level data.
- *06/2022*: **EPSA Annual Conference**, Prague, Czechia — *Presentation:* Does state funding of political parties reduce political corruption? Evidence from the post-communist space.
- *04/2022*: **ECPR Joint Sessions**, Virtual — *Workshop Co-Chair & Presentation:* Does Public Funding of Parties Reduce Corruption? Evidence from Firm-Level Data.
- *04/2022*: **MPSA Annual Conference**, Virtual — *Presentation:* Does State Funding of Political Parties Reduce Political Corruption? Evidence from the Post-Communist Space.
- *09/2021*: **ECPR General Conference**, Virtual — *Presentation:* Does state funding of political parties deter political corruption? New insights from hard data.
- *07/2017*: **IPSA-RC20 – Political Finance and Political Corruption Biennial Meeting**, Valencia, Spain — *Presentation:* Assessing the Restrictiveness of Party Funding Regimes: Towards an Analytical Framework.
- *09/2016*: **ECPR General Conference**, Prague, Czechia — *Presentation:* Similar Challenges – Different Outcomes: Addressing the Supply and Demand Sides of Party Funding Regulations in Post-Communist Space.

Academic community service

- *04/2022*: **Co-Chair**, ECPR Joint Sessions Workshop: *Measuring Corruption: State of the Art, Challenges, and Advancements*, University of Edinburgh.
- *05/2022*: **Co-organiser & Instructor**, Workshop: *Introduction to Data Management with R*, School of Law and Government & Anti-Corruption Research Centre, Dublin City University.
- *05/2022*: **Co-organiser & Instructor**, Workshop: *Introduction to Data Visualisation with R*, School of Law and Government & Anti-Corruption Research Centre, Dublin City University.
- *2020–2025*: **Reviewer**, Journals: *Party Politics*, *Representation*, *Problems of Post-Communism*, *Journal of Public Affairs*, *Journal of European Integration*, *Governance*, *Government & Opposition*.

Skills

- **Research software**: R/RStudio — proficient in data collection (including web scraping), management, analysis, and visualisation.
- **Microsoft Office**: Excel, Outlook, PowerPoint, Word — proficient.
- **Languages**: Romanian — mother tongue; Russian — native-level proficiency; English — fluent; Italian — advanced.